

VPS Installation and Update Instructions

Technician guide for the Maricho Media production server

SERVER

64.247.178.45

DOMAIN

mshauri.marichomedia.com

REPOSITORY

github.com/seanndlovu/Mshauri
-AI-Advisor

For an existing installation: go directly to “Routine Git update” on page 4. The repository contains the update script at `deploy/3-update.sh`.

Security: never commit `deploy/.env.production`, database passwords, Clerk keys, session secrets, or the configured Owner email to Git.

1. Point the domain to the VPS

Create or update this DNS record for **marichomedia.com**:

```
Type: A
Name: mshauri
Value: 64.247.178.45
TTL: 300 or Auto
```

Confirm it resolves correctly:

```
nslookup mshauri.marichomedia.com
```

2. Connect and download Mshauri

```
ssh root@64.247.178.45
mkdir -p /var/www
cd /var/www
git clone https://github.com/seanndlovu/Mshauri-AI-Advisor.git mshauri
cd /var/www/mshauri
```

If the repository already exists, do not clone it again:

```
cd /var/www/mshauri
git pull --ff-only origin main
```

3. Install server software

Run this once on a new Ubuntu VPS:

```
cd /var/www/mshauri  
sudo bash deploy/1-install-vps.sh
```

This installs Node.js, pnpm, PM2, PostgreSQL, Nginx and Certbot.

4. Configure the production environment

```
cd /var/www/mshauri
cp deploy/.env.example deploy/.env.production
nano deploy/.env.production
```

Complete the values described in the file. Authentication requires the production Clerk credentials and these settings:

Setting	Purpose
CLERK_SECRET_KEY	Server-side Clerk authentication key.
VITE_CLERK_PUBLISHABLE_KEY	Public Clerk key used by the web application.
SESSION_SECRET	Long random value used to secure server sessions.
OWNER_BOOTSTRAP_EMAIL	Verified email permitted to claim the first Owner role. Configure the approved first Owner email.
APP_ORIGIN	https://mshauri.marichomedia.com

Generate a session secret if needed:

```
openssl rand -hex 32
```

Use Clerk **production** keys on the VPS. Add `mshauri.marichomedia.com` to the production Clerk instance and configure the permitted redirect/origin settings there.

5. Build and launch the first installation

```
cd /var/www/mshauri
bash deploy/2-setup-app.sh
```

The setup script installs packages, configures PostgreSQL, builds the API and website, applies the database schema, configures Nginx and starts the API with PM2.

6. Enable HTTPS

Only continue after DNS resolves to the VPS:

```
sudo certbot --nginx -d mshauri.marichomedia.com
sudo nginx -t
sudo systemctl reload nginx
```

7. Verify the first installation

```
pm2 status
pm2 logs mshauri-api --lines 50
sudo nginx -t
curl -I https://mshauri.marichomedia.com
```

Open <https://mshauri.marichomedia.com> in a browser and test sign-in.

8. Activate Owner and staff access

1. Sign in using the verified Clerk or Google account matching `OWNER_BOOTSTRAP_EMAIL`.
2. Open `https://mshauri.marichomedia.com/admin/staff`.
3. Claim the first Owner role.
4. Additional staff must register or sign in once with their own verified email.
5. The Owner can then assign Owner, Market Price Editor, Ad Manager, or No Staff Access.

The final remaining Owner cannot be removed or downgraded. Staff continue to use their own personal login details; assigning a role does not create or reveal a password.

9. Staff-access audit history

The current release permanently records staff role changes in PostgreSQL. The update script applies the required database schema automatically. Owners can review the history from the Staff Access area.

10. Routine Git update

After new code has been pushed to GitHub:

```
ssh root@64.247.178.45
cd /var/www/mshauri
bash deploy/3-update.sh
```

The script performs the following work:

- Runs `git pull --ff-only`.
- Reconciles PostgreSQL access and installs dependencies.
- Builds the API and frontend.
- Applies database schema changes.
- Restarts `mshauri-api` with PM2.

Verify the update:

```
pm2 status
pm2 logs mshauri-api --lines 50
curl -I https://mshauri.marichomedia.com
```

If `git pull --ff-only` fails: do not run a forced reset until any local VPS changes have been reviewed and backed up. Check `git status` and preserve `deploy/.env.production` and uploaded advert files.

11. Useful maintenance commands

Purpose	Command
API status	<code>pm2 status</code>
API logs	<code>pm2 logs mshauri-api</code>
Restart API	<code>pm2 restart mshauri-api --update-env</code>
Test Nginx	<code>sudo nginx -t</code>
Reload Nginx	<code>sudo systemctl reload nginx</code>
PostgreSQL status	<code>sudo systemctl status postgresql</code>
Certificate status	<code>sudo certbot certificates</code>
Find update script	<code>sudo find / -type f -path "*/deploy/3-update.sh" 2>/dev/null</code>

12. Common problems

Problem	Action
<code>deploy/3-update.sh</code> not found	Enter the cloned repository directory first, normally <code>/var/www/mshauri</code> .
API is offline	Run <code>pm2 logs mshauri-api --lines 100</code> and check environment/database errors.
Database schema error after update	Run <code>bash deploy/3-update.sh</code> again after fixing the reported database configuration.
Clerk login fails	Check production Clerk keys, domain configuration, HTTPS, and application origin.
First Owner cannot claim access	Confirm the signed-in Clerk identity is verified and exactly matches <code>OWNER_BOOTSTRAP_EMAIL</code> .
Port 80 already in use	Check <code>sudo lsof -i :80</code> ; disable Apache if it conflicts with Nginx.